

Civics/Ethics





About the Course

Students study citizenship topics of political engagement as a way to love our neighbors, relationships in a technological world, and understanding our consciences.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 12



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
12	Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 1 time/week 40 min	The Life We're Looking For: Reclaiming Relationship in a Technological World Conscience: What It Is, How to Train It, and Loving Those Who Differ Citizenship Without Illusions: A Christian Guide to Political Engagement

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 12				
Civics/Ethics: Grade 12	Current Events: Grades 9-12	Economics: Grade 12		Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Civics/Ethics: Grade 12



The Life We're Looking For: Reclaiming Relationship in a Technological World



Conscience: What It Is, How to Train It, and Loving Those Who Differ



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Civics/Ethics: Grade 12

How To Approach



Prepare

If you, the student, are learning at home, work to schedule a time with your teacher when you can complete the lessons from *Ourselves* or your Ethics reading together, as these lessons are much richer when shared and discussed.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources: Scan the headlines first to get an overview, and then choose a story to read.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen for the time assigned. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Keep an eye out for quotes to put in your commonplace book or events or characters to put down in your *Book of Centuries*.



Narrate

Process and integrate your reading by narrating either orally or in writing. Some lesson plans will give you a suggestion of how best to narrate. To keep yourself on track, you might want to set a timer so you stop reading with enough time to narrate.



Connect

After your narration, think about how what you read connects to other subjects, other books, other things you've read or watched, or seen in the past or present. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions together to discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Record important ideas in your Citizenship Notebooks. Make a calendar of current events.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. You may also want to preview and choose which news sites to offer students.

Those educating at home might pick one lesson to read aloud (such as the Ethics readings on Cultural Engagement, Conscience, etc.) with their students to keep up the habit of oral narration and foster conversation and relationship and then simply give students these lesson plans and the rest of the books and check in with them throughout the term for conversation, support, and accountability.

It is valuable for those in a classroom setting to also have a mix of lessons, which students complete themselves silently, and others read aloud and narrated together. Classroom settings lend themselves well to additional discussion and sharing at the end of lessons, after everyone has narrated either together or independently in writing.



Term 1

WEEK 1 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 1

Materials: Citizenship Without Illusions, journal or notebook, Bible

→ INTRO

Citizenship Without Illusions provides the reader with insightful ways to participate in the cultural and political landscape without setting aside one's spiritual convictions to do so. The author addresses numerous topics, including voting, community engagement, working with individuals with different political ideologies, introduces why global concerns have a place in local and national politics, and explains how the local church has an important role in equipping individuals to be good citizens. The author grounds his approach in the reality that Christians are to love God with their heart, soul, mind, and strength, which results in loving their neighbor as themselves.

→ READ

Ch.1 p.1-12, and review the biblical passages referenced.

→ WRITTEN NARRATION

Write a narration that describes a few of the communities that you belong to. (Examples of these communities would be church, homeschool co-op, sports team, etc.) Which of these communities provides you with the greatest sense of belonging? Which of these communities emphasizes the importance of citizenship?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: American Democracy

WEEK 2 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 2

Materials: Citizenship Without Illusions, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.2 p.13-29, and review the biblical passages referenced.

→ REFLECT

Reflecting on the communities you identified last week, determine which communities align with a sacred/secular understanding of cultural engagement and which ones align with a Christian worldview understanding of cultural engagement.

WEEK 3 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 3

Materials: Citizenship Without Illusions, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.3 p.30-40 "in chapter six," and review the biblical passages referenced.

→ WRITTEN NARRATION

In light of the reading, narrate what it means to be a citizen. Identify someone to discuss the importance of *thinking local* as a citizen.

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 4 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 4

Materials: Citizenship Without Illusions, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.3 p.40 (Responding When Called) - p.49, and review the biblical passages referenced.

→ WRITE & REFLECT

Write a letter to a friend living in a country that discourages healthy citizenry. Reflecting on the reading for this lesson, how would you encourage the person?

WEEK 5 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 5

Materials: Citizenship Without Illusions, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.4 p.50-62, and review the biblical passages referenced.

→ WRITE

Provide a written narration of the four proposed principles suggested by the author to navigate injustice and civil disobedience. What additional principles would you add?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: What Does Separation of Church and State Mean?

WEEK 6 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 6

Materials: Citizenship Without Illusions, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.5 p.63-72 "aggregation of local interests," and review the biblical passages referenced.

→ EXPLAIN

Explain why voting is important for a healthy citizenry. Identify something that stood out to you from the reading.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Rights and Responsibilities

WEEK 7 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 7

Materials: Citizenship Without Illusions, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.5 p.72 (Making Every Vote Count) - p.86, and review the biblical passages referenced.



Term 1

→ EXPLAIN

How would you explain the election process in the United States? How should a person's religious views inform their understanding of citizenship?

WEEK 8 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 8

Materials: Citizenship Without Illusions, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.6 p.87-105, and review the biblical passages referenced.

→ REFLECT & LIST

Reflect on how familiar you are with your neighbors and with your local government officials. Make a list of action steps that would enable you to become more involved relationally and politically.

WEEK 9 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 9

Materials: Citizenship Without Illusions, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.7 p.106-125, and review the biblical passages referenced.

→ DESCRIBE

Describe the differences between progressives and conservatives. Why is it important for both groups to find common ground?

WEEK 10 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 10

Materials: Citizenship Without Illusions, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.8 p.126-134, and review the biblical passages referenced.

→ EXPLAIN

Explain how the gospel informs both a local and global commitment to being a good citizen. Discuss how the gospel can prevent attachments to political ideologies that can hinder local and global citizenship.

WEEK 11 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 11

Materials: Citizenship Without Illusions, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.9 p.135-146, and review the biblical passages referenced.

→ DESCRIBE & REFLECT OR INTERVIEW

In your journal, describe the local church's role in cultivating healthy citizens. Reflect on the ways your own faith community assists in cultivating healthy citizens.

or

Interview a pastoral leader in your faith community. Develop a list of questions in

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Term 1	
advance that will reveal how your faith community cultivates healthy citizens. For example, how do the pastors of the church lead the congregation to pray for local and global leaders? How does the church equip individuals to see their vocations as platforms to share the gospel and contribute positively to society?	
WEEK 12 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Citizenship Without Illusions: A Christian Guide To Political Engagement	



Term 2

WEEK 1 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 13

Materials: The Life We're Looking For, journal or notebook, Bible

→INTRO

God has created us to be in healthy relationships. Unfortunately, numerous cultural factors work against the cultivation of healthy relationships that we often fail to recognize. This term, you will explore how technology impacts human flourishing both positively and negatively. You will be challenged to think deeply about your convictions regarding technology's impact on human relationships, and you will be presented with a way to combat the encroachment of technology and reclaim healthy human relationships.

Before you begin, read the short articles *How to Mark a Book* by Mortimer Adler and *Not Only One Way to Mark a Book*. This will equip you with reading techniques to help you interact with the reading in a deeper and more meaningful manner.

∞ Article Link: [How to Mark a Book](#)

∞ PDF Link: [Not One Way to Mark a Book](#)

→ READ

Ch.1 p.3-20

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

WEEK 2 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 14

Materials: The Life We're Looking For, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.2 p.21-39

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ WRITE

Looking back on the reading as needed, in your journal, explain what it means to be a person. If time permits, read Genesis 2:1-24.

WEEK 3 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 15

Materials: The Life We're Looking For, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.3 p.40-59

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.



Term 2	
→ CONTRAST Looking back on the reading as needed, in your journal, contrast the "superpower zone" with "flow." Reflect on a time when you experienced "flow."	
WEEK 4 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 16 Materials: The Life We're Looking For, journal or notebook, Bible → READ Ch.4-5 p.60-81 → NARRATE Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading. → DEFINE Define Mammon and list a few examples of what Mammon demands. If time permits, read Matthew 6:19-24 for additional support.	
WEEK 5 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 17 Materials: The Life We're Looking For, journal or notebook, Bible → READ Ch.6 p.82-100 "The word robot" - "technology would provide." → NARRATE Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading. → EXPLAIN In your journal, explain what a "cyborg" is and provide examples of how humans may be "voluntarily embedding" themselves in technology. What "digital systems" are you embedded in?	
WEEK 6 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 18 Materials: The Life We're Looking For, journal or notebook, Bible → READ Ch.6-7 p.100-120 "In December 2013," - "is a person." → NARRATE Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading. → WRITE Looking back on the reading, write in your journal two ideas that stood out to you.	



Term 2

WEEK 7 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 19

Materials: The Life We're Looking For, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.8-9 p.121-138 "Gaius, Tertius, and" - "it is today."

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ CONTRAST

In your journal, contrast "instrument" and "device." Why is this distinction important?

WEEK 8 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 20

Materials: The Life We're Looking For, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.9-10 p.138-159 "Every technical advance" - "by another face."

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ WRITE

Looking back on the reading as needed, explain the difference between a "family" and a "household." Describe the individuals who comprise your household.

WEEK 9 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 21

Materials: The Life We're Looking For, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.10 p.159-169 "So our next" - "that new shelter."

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ EXPLAIN

In your journal, explain the importance of "canopies of trust."

WEEK 10 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 22

Materials: The Life We're Looking For, journal or notebook, Bible

→ READ

Ch.11 p.170-193

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

Term 2	
→ REFLECT Read Paul's letter to Philemon and identify what changed in Onesimus' life that led him to return home.	
WEEK 11 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 23 Materials: The Life We're Looking For, journal or notebook, Bible → READ Ch.12 p.194-213 → NARRATE Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading. → CONCEPT MAP Use a concept map to reveal the chain of persons who have played a significant role in your life.	
WEEK 12 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: The Life We're Looking For: Reclaiming Relationship in a Technological World	



Term 3

WEEK 1 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 25

Materials: Conscience: What it is, How to Train it, and Loving Those Who Differ; notebook

→ READ

Do an inspectional reading, then read the Foreword & Preface

→ NARRATE

As you read the book, write the main ideas and any scripture supported in your notebook. Add your questions and reflections.

Discuss with your teacher.

WEEK 2 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 26

Materials: Conscience, notebook

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1

- What was your idea or definition of “conscience” before reading this chapter? Was it affected or changed by reading this chapter? How?

WEEK 3 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 27

Materials: Conscience, notebook

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2

Discuss your thoughts about this chapter.

WEEK 4 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 28

Materials: Conscience, notebook

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3

- What should you do when your conscience condemns you?

WEEK 5 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 29

Materials: Conscience, notebook

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4 p.55-68 beginning of chapter - “(Gal. 2:11-14)”

- How should you calibrate your conscience?

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Term 3

WEEK 6 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 30

Materials: Conscience, notebook

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4 p.68-83 "Examples That Illustrate" - end of the chapter

- What issues might you need to calibrate your conscience?

WEEK 7 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 31

Materials: Conscience, notebook

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 p.84-96 beginning of chapter - "in our churches."

- How should you relate to fellow Christians when your consciences disagree?

WEEK 8 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 32

Materials: Conscience, notebook

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 p.96-105 "Twelve Principles about" - "was his goal."

- Which principles stand out to you to think more about?

WEEK 9 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 33

Materials: Conscience, notebook

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 p.106-117 "Assume that others" - end of the chapter

- Which principles stand out to you to think more about?

WEEK 10 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 34

Materials: Conscience, notebook

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.118-128 beginning of chapter - "much more difficult."

- How should you relate to people in other cultures when your consciences disagree?

WEEK 11 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 35

Materials: Conscience, notebook

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.129 "What Stays?" - Ch.7

If interested in a Q and A session with one of the authors:

∞ **Video Link:** Conscience

Term 3	
• How should you relate to people in other cultures when your consciences disagree?	
WEEK 12 40m Civics/Ethics: Grade 12 - Lesson 36 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Conscience: What it is, How to Train it, and Loving Those who Differ	

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Examination

Term 1

· Citizenship Without Illusions: Reflecting on the reading from this course, describe what it means to be a healthy citizen locally, nationally, and globally. Include biblical references for each category.

Term 2

· Choose one of the following to answer:

What are four things you learned from The Life We're Looking For that are causing you to interact with technology differently?

Or

What did you learn from The Life We're Looking For regarding the importance of human relationships?

Term 3

· Conscience: What it is, How to Train it, and Loving Those who Differ: What is the conscience, how do you train it, and how do we love others despite differences? How should you "calibrate your conscience"?